



ARES ELITE SPORTS VISION

Beginner Sports Performance Drills

A 4-week starter program · 2 drills a day

8 core drills · Beginner level · 10-15 minutes daily

- Near-Far Jumps (Level 1)
- Eye Circles
- Figure 8's Drill
- ABC's (Level 1)
- Eye Contractions
- Superior Oblique Muscles
- Pencil Push-Ups
- Eye Massage (Superior Rectus)

Equipment needed: a pencil and a window. That's it.

How this program works

Two drills a day, cycled across four weeks.

This program takes the eight core vision drills and spreads them across 28 days. Each day you do TWO drills — a different pairing every day — so no single system gets overworked and every drill gets trained evenly (each appears seven times across the program).

- **Do 2 drills per day**

Follow the schedule on the next pages, or shuffle freely — the point is two drills daily.

- **Train 3-4 weeks**

Run the full 28 days. Most people notice smoother, easier eye movement in the first two weeks.

- **Quality over speed**

Slow and controlled beats fast and sloppy. Never force a movement that hurts.

- **Stop if it strains**

Mild fatigue is normal. Sharp pain, headache, or dizziness means stop and rest.

WHAT YOU NEED

- A pencil (for Figure 8's and Pencil Push-Ups)
- A window with a long-distance view (for Near-Far Jumps)

The Core Drills

What it does, how to do it, and how much.

Near-Far Jumps (Level 1)

BEGINNER

EQUIPMENT None (a dry-erase marker helps)

PURPOSE To develop strength in the focusing system (the accommodative system), which drives your ability to jump back and forth between distance and near objects efficiently.

PROCEDURE

- 1 Stand in front of a window with a long-distance view, about 18-20 inches from the glass.
- 2 Cover your left eye first, keeping your right eye open.
- 3 Find the furthest object you can see in the distance — this is your DISTANCE target.
- 4 Pick a speck of dirt on the glass (or place a dry-erase mark) — this is your NEAR target.
- 5 Shift focus back and forth between the two, holding each for 5 seconds.

COMPLETE: 25 cycles (1 cycle = distance → near → distance)

Eye Circles

BEGINNER

EQUIPMENT None

PURPOSE To build smooth, controlled range of motion through the full orbit of eye movement.

PROCEDURE

- 1 Keep your eyes open and move them in a clockwise direction.
- 2 If this feels uncomfortable, close your eyes and perform the same movement.
- 3 Circle the eyes around 20 times.
- 4 Repeat, circling in the counterclockwise direction.

COMPLETE: 20 circles clockwise + 20 counterclockwise

The Core Drills

What it does, how to do it, and how much.

Figure 8's Drill

BEGINNER**EQUIPMENT** Pencil**PURPOSE** To train the system that controls how your eyes move together while following an object — your Smooth Pursuits.**PROCEDURE**

- 1 Hold a pencil out at arm's length in front of you.
- 2 Make a figure-8 design in the air with the pencil.
- 3 Without moving your head — using only your eyes — follow the pencil tip through the air.
- 4 Move the pencil slowly at first, tracing a small figure 8.
- 5 As you get more proficient, increase both the speed and the size of the figure 8.

COMPLETE: 15 figure 8's clockwise + 15 counterclockwise

ABC's (Level 1)

BEGINNER**EQUIPMENT** None**PURPOSE** To move your eyes together quickly and efficiently, strengthening the system as a whole for both strength and quickness.**PROCEDURE**

- 1 Stare straight ahead.
- 2 Beginning with the letter A, trace the letter using only your eyes.
- 3 Keep your head straight at all times and draw an exaggerated, large version of the letter.
- 4 Repeat with every letter of the alphabet, from A through Z.

COMPLETE: 1 complete cycle through the capital alphabet

The Core Drills

What it does, how to do it, and how much.

Eye Contractions

BEGINNER

EQUIPMENT None

PURPOSE To build control of the muscles that close and open the eye, and to flush strain through rapid blinking.

PROCEDURE

- 1 Close your eyes as tightly as possible and hold for 4 seconds.
- 2 Open your eyes and blink as quickly as possible 15 times.
- 3 Rest briefly, then repeat.

COMPLETE: 5 sets

Superior Oblique Muscles

BEGINNER

EQUIPMENT None

PURPOSE To strengthen the muscles of the eye to improve control and function through diagonal movement patterns.

PROCEDURE

- 1 Sit or stand in a comfortable position.
- 2 Trace an invisible figure 8 along the floor about 8-10 feet in front of you — without moving your head.
- 3 Trace the lines in one direction, then switch and trace the other direction.

COMPLETE: 3-5 sets

The Core Drills

What it does, how to do it, and how much.

Pencil Push-Ups

BEGINNER

EQUIPMENT Pencil

PURPOSE To train the part of your vision that moves your eyes in opposite directions at the same time — Convergence (in) and Divergence (out).

PROCEDURE

- 1 Hold a pencil out at arm's length in front of you.
- 2 Focusing on the tip of the sharpened edge, slowly bring the pencil toward your nose.
- 3 When you see 2 pencil tips (your vision has split), push it back out slightly until you see 1 again.
- 4 Focus on the tip for 10 seconds, then push it back out to arm's length.

COMPLETE: 15 cycles (in from arm's length → hold 10 sec → back out)

Eye Massage (Superior Rectus)

BEGINNER

EQUIPMENT None

PURPOSE To relieve strain and stress while massaging the muscles that surround and support the eyeball, keeping them stretched and limber.

PROCEDURE

- 1 Find a comfortable position and close your eyes.
- 2 Place your thumbs gently below the eyebrows, at the inside corners of the eyes near the nose.
- 3 Rest your other four fingers on your forehead.
- 4 Apply gentle inward pressure with the thumbs and count to four.
- 5 Using the index finger and thumb, massage the bridge of the nose, counting to four as pressure is applied.
- 6 Repeat the sequence four times.

COMPLETE: 3-5 minutes per day

The 4-Week Schedule

Two drills a day, cycled and randomized for even coverage.

WEEK 1

Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
Day 1 Pencil Push-Ups Eye Massage	Day 2 Figure 8's Eye Contractions	Day 3 Near-Far Jumps ABC's L1	Day 4 Eye Circles Superior Oblique	Day 5 Figure 8's ABC's L1	Day 6 Eye Circles Eye Massage	Day 7 Near-Far Jumps Pencil Push-Ups

WEEK 2

Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
Day 8 Eye Contractions Superior Oblique	Day 9 Eye Contractions Eye Massage	Day 10 Figure 8's Superior Oblique	Day 11 Near-Far Jumps Eye Circles	Day 12 ABC's L1 Pencil Push-Ups	Day 13 ABC's L1 Superior Oblique	Day 14 Eye Circles Figure 8's

WEEK 3

Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
Day 15 Eye Contractions Eye Massage	Day 16 Near-Far Jumps Pencil Push-Ups	Day 17 Figure 8's Eye Contractions	Day 18 ABC's L1 Superior Oblique	Day 19 Eye Circles Eye Massage	Day 20 Near-Far Jumps Pencil Push-Ups	Day 21 Eye Circles Superior Oblique

WEEK 4

Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
Day 22 ABC's L1 Eye Massage	Day 23 Near-Far Jumps Pencil Push-Ups	Day 24 Figure 8's Eye Contractions	Day 25 ABC's L1 Superior Oblique	Day 26 Near-Far Jumps Figure 8's	Day 27 Pencil Push-Ups Eye Massage	Day 28 Eye Circles Eye Contractions

Each drill appears 7 times across the 28 days. Swap days freely if your schedule shifts — just keep it to two drills daily.

28-Day Progress Tracker

Check off each day. Consistency is the whole game.

WEEK 1

☐	Day 1	Pencil Push-Ups + Eye Massage	notes / how it felt
☐	Day 2	Figure 8's + Eye Contractions	notes / how it felt
☐	Day 3	Near-Far Jumps + ABC's L1	notes / how it felt
☐	Day 4	Eye Circles + Superior Oblique	notes / how it felt
☐	Day 5	Figure 8's + ABC's L1	notes / how it felt
☐	Day 6	Eye Circles + Eye Massage	notes / how it felt
☐	Day 7	Near-Far Jumps + Pencil Push-Ups	notes / how it felt

WEEK 2

☐	Day 8	Eye Contractions + Superior Oblique	notes / how it felt
☐	Day 9	Eye Contractions + Eye Massage	notes / how it felt
☐	Day 10	Figure 8's + Superior Oblique	notes / how it felt
☐	Day 11	Near-Far Jumps + Eye Circles	notes / how it felt
☐	Day 12	ABC's L1 + Pencil Push-Ups	notes / how it felt
☐	Day 13	ABC's L1 + Superior Oblique	notes / how it felt
☐	Day 14	Eye Circles + Figure 8's	notes / how it felt

WEEK 3

☐	Day 15	Eye Contractions + Eye Massage	notes / how it felt
☐	Day 16	Near-Far Jumps + Pencil Push-Ups	notes / how it felt
☐	Day 17	Figure 8's + Eye Contractions	notes / how it felt
☐	Day 18	ABC's L1 + Superior Oblique	notes / how it felt
☐	Day 19	Eye Circles + Eye Massage	notes / how it felt
☐	Day 20	Near-Far Jumps + Pencil Push-Ups	notes / how it felt
☐	Day 21	Eye Circles + Superior Oblique	notes / how it felt

WEEK 4

☐	Day 22	ABC's L1 + Eye Massage	notes / how it felt
☐	Day 23	Near-Far Jumps + Pencil Push-Ups	notes / how it felt
☐	Day 24	Figure 8's + Eye Contractions	notes / how it felt
☐	Day 25	ABC's L1 + Superior Oblique	notes / how it felt
☐	Day 26	Near-Far Jumps + Figure 8's	notes / how it felt
☐	Day 27	Pencil Push-Ups + Eye Massage	notes / how it felt
☐	Day 28	Eye Circles + Eye Contractions	notes / how it felt



Train the system, not just the eyes.

These eight drills build your base. When you're ready to understand WHY they work — and how elite athletes acquire, route, execute, and synchronize what they see — the A.R.E.S. Performance Loop series takes you all the way there.

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This guide is educational and is not medical or optometric advice. These are general vision-training exercises, not a diagnosis or treatment for any condition. If you have double vision, eye pain, headaches, or any vision concern, stop and consult a qualified eye-care professional.